

Why don't I see more people upset about how bad bitcoin is for environment vs AI?

Posted by u/Alert-Supermarket-82 • 0 points • 12 comments

Maybe it's just the circles I'm in, but I feel like more people are mad about AI environmental harm

Comments

u/Zealousideal-Fun3917 • 2 points • 2026-01-30 01:03 UTC

You're comparing gonorrhea and syphilis.

u/notextinctyet • 1 points • 2026-01-30 00:38 UTC

Solely because bitcoin is yesterday's news. Of the two, bitcoin is worse.

Bitcoin is really, really, **really** bad for the environment because improvements in energy efficiency drive increases in energy usage. It's precisely backwards from how it should be. If bitcoins get cheaper to mine by any means, then everyone has to increase their spend to keep up or other miners will gain a dominant position over the network. So bitcoin is bad for the environment proportional to the value of mined bitcoin regardless of how efficient it is made. It's atrocious.

AI is bad for the environment because it's inefficient now, but at least it's theoretically possible to improve on that. And it's bad because it's overused, but it's theoretically possible to improve on that as well. It's impossible to improve on proof-by-work crypto. Unless it's made not proof-by-work entirely, which has yet to be done.

u/LurkerByNatureGT • 2 points • 2026-01-30 00:13 UTC

1) It's just the circles you are in

2) there is more chatter around the current buzzwords in general. When blockchain was the big buzzword, people were **all over** how bad bitcoin is for the environment.

u/Otherwise-Relief2248 • 0 points • 2026-01-29 23:50 UTC

Because bitcoin doesn't threaten people's jobs.

u/Sett_86 • 3 points • 2026-01-29 22:51 UTC

Because bitcoin is miniscule by comparison. Even at the peak of the crypto boom, it was a niche thing. AI, on the other hand, is completely out of scale - as in some predictions estimate by 2030 AI will be consuming as much electricity as everything else combined.

u/Alesus2-0 • 2 points • 2026-01-29 22:35 UTC

AI is the the newer, more prominent concern. People are focused on what's topical.

Additionally, I think that a lot of people are anxious about AI and it's potential economic and social impacts. They're looking for concrete, objective reasons to object to AI, and environmental concerns provide such a rationale.

By contrast, crypto is less novel. It seems apparent that the original claims that crypto will upend the financial system are basically untrue. So crypto speculation falls into the 'Silly' category rather than 'Worrying'. There isn't the same sense of urgency around cracking down on it.

u/BlackSparrowSF • 8 points • 2026-01-29 22:32 UTC

Because bitcoin didn't cause such a loud mess. They worked in their own environment, and it was up to you to get in. Sure, they raised the GPU and RAM demand, but they weren't building neighborhoods - worth of mining centers, unlike AI.

And you can choose to get into bitcoins, but every company is looking for ways to invasively implement AI (aka, shove it down our throats on every single thing we own) to delay the pop of the bubble.

u/c0i9z • 2 points • 2026-01-29 22:31 UTC

People are upset about how bad bitcoin is for the environment, but you don't see as much promotion of bitcoin lately and it seems to have plateaued.

u/gleaming-the-cubicle • 8 points • 2026-01-29 22:24 UTC

The same people talking about AI being bad said the same about Bitcoin a decade ago

u/rgbvalue • 2 points • 2026-01-29 22:23 UTC

prob because the biggest tech companies in the world aren't pouring billions of dollars into bitcoin

u/Fit-Technology5546 • 1 points • 2026-01-29 22:22 UTC

Because bitcoin has been around longer so people either got used to it or already picked their side. AI is the new shiny thing everyone's freaking out about right now

Plus crypto bros are way more annoying to argue with than AI people lol

u/ForScale • 2 points • 2026-01-29 22:21 UTC

Cause it's not the trendier, newer one. People like to hop on current bandwagons much more than older ones.